

Yes. The **no-code/low-code ecosystem is very large**, and it is useful to divide it by what you actually want to create: websites, web applications, mobile apps, desktop/standalone software, internal business applications, databases/backends, automation, AI applications, and complete SaaS products.

A key distinction: **“no-code” does not mean every tool can create every kind of software**. For example, Webflow is primarily a website/CMS builder, Bubble is much more suitable for complex web applications, FlutterFlow is strong for mobile applications, while Retool is aimed at internal business tools. ([Resources Rework](#))

1. What is No-Code?

No-code development means creating software using visual interfaces—drag-and-drop components, forms, workflows, databases, configuration panels, templates, and visual logic—instead of writing traditional programming code.

Example

Traditional development:

```
Java/Spring Boot
  ↓
Database
  ↓
REST API
  ↓
React/Angular
  ↓
Web Browser
```

No-code development:

```
Visual App Builder
  ↓
Drag & Drop UI
  ↓
Visual Workflow
  ↓
Built-in Database
  ↓
```

Publish

The major advantage is speed and accessibility. The major trade-off is that you become dependent on the platform's capabilities, pricing, deployment model, and limitations. ([Roy Digital App Studio](#))

2. Master List of No-Code / Low-Code Software Development Tools

The following table organizes the major tools by their primary purpose.

#	Category	Website / Tool	What it is	What you can create	Coding required?	Example
1	Full web application	Bubble	Full visual application platform	SaaS, marketplaces, portals, dashboards	No	CRM SaaS
2	Web application	WeWeb	Visual frontend application builder	SaaS, portals, dashboards	No/Low	Customer portal
3	Web application	Softp	No-code web app and portal builder	Portals, directories, member apps	No	Employee portal
4	Web application	Glide	Data/spreadsheet-driven app builder	Internal apps, mobile web apps	No	Inventory app
5	Web application	Adalo	Visual application builder	Mobile/web apps	No	Booking app
6	Web/mobile	FlutterFlow	Visual application development platform	iOS, Android, web and desktop-oriented apps	Low/No for many workflows	Banking prototype
7	Web/mobile	Jotform Apps	Form/data-based app builder	Forms, workflow apps, simple business apps	No	Employee request app

8	Mobile	Thunkable	Visual mobile application builder	Android/iOS apps	No	Fitness app
9	Mobile	GoodBarber	No-code mobile app builder	Native mobile apps	No	Retail app
10	Mobile	BuildFire	Mobile app platform	Business/mobile apps	No	Customer app
11	Mobile	Bravo Studio	Design-to-mobile-app platform	Mobile apps from designs	No/Low	Figma → mobile app
12	Mobile	Draftbit	Visual React Native app builder	Mobile applications	Low	Marketplace app
13	Website	Webflow	Visual website/CMS builder	Websites, CMS sites, marketing sites	No/Low	Corporate website
14	Website	Framer	Visual website builder	Landing pages, websites	No	Startup website
15	Website	Wix	Website/business platform	Websites, stores, booking sites	No	Restaurant website
16	Website	Squarespace	Website builder	Business websites, portfolios	No	Portfolio
17	Website	Shopify	E-commerce platform	Online stores	No	Online shop
18	Website	WordPress + Elementor	Visual CMS/site-building combination	Websites, blogs, portals	No/Low	Company website
19	Internal tools	Retool	Internal application builder	Admin panels, dashboards, operations apps	Low/No	Admin dashboard

20	Internal tools	Appsmith	Open-source internal-tool builder	Dashboards, CRUD applications	Low/No	Employee management
21	Internal tools	Budibase	Open-source low-code platform	Business applications	Low/No	Inventory system
22	Internal tools	ToolJet	Internal tool platform	Admin panels, dashboards	Low/No	Operations dashboard
23	Enterprise	Microsoft Power Apps	Microsoft's low-code application platform	Business apps	Low/No	HR application
24	Enterprise	Google AppSheet	Google's no-code app platform	Business/mobile apps	No	Field-service app
25	Enterprise	Zoho Creator	Low-code business application platform	CRM, workflows, business apps	Low/No	Leave management
26	Enterprise	SAP Build Apps	Enterprise application builder	Business applications	Low/No	Procurement app
27	Enterprise	Betty Blocks	Enterprise no-code platform	Business applications	No/Low	Case management
28	Database → app	Airtable	Spreadsheet/database hybrid	Databases, interfaces, simple apps	No	Project tracker
29	Database → app	Baserow	Open-source database platform	Databases and applications	No	CRM
30	Database → app	NocoDB	Open-source Airtable alternative	Database interfaces	No	Inventory database
31	Database/backend	Xano	No-code backend platform	APIs, databases, backend logic	No/Low	SaaS backend

32	Backend	Backendless	Backend-as-a-service platform	APIs, databases, mobile/web backends	No/Low	Chat backend
33	Backend	Firebase	Backend platform	Authentication, database, APIs, hosting	Low/No depending on use	Mobile backend
34	Backend	Supabase	Open-source backend platform	Database, authentication, APIs	Low	SaaS backend
35	Automation	Zapier	Workflow automation platform	Automated business processes	No	Gmail → Slack
36	Automation	Make	Visual automation platform	Complex workflows	No/Low	CRM automation
37	Automation	n8n	Workflow automation platform	APIs, integrations, AI workflows	Low/No	Data pipeline
38	Automation	Power Automate	Microsoft workflow platform	Business automation	No/Low	Invoice workflow
39	Automation	Pipedream	Integration/automation platform	API workflows	Low	API integration
40	Forms/apps	Jotform	Form and workflow platform	Forms, applications, approvals	No	Registration system
41	Forms/apps	Typeform	Interactive form platform	Surveys, forms, lead capture	No	Customer survey
42	Forms/apps	Fillout	Advanced form builder	Forms, workflows	No	Application form
43	AI app builder	Lovable	AI application builder	Web apps, SaaS prototypes	Minimal	AI CRM

44	AI app builder	Bolt.new	AI development platform	Web applications	Minimal/Low	SaaS prototype
45	AI app builder	Replit	AI-assisted development environment	Websites, apps and software	Low/No for many tasks	AI-generated web app
46	AI app builder	Base44	AI-powered application builder	Complete web applications	No/Minimal	Business application
47	AI app builder	v0	AI UI/application generation platform	Web interfaces/apps	Low	React dashboard
48	AI app builder	Base44-style AI builders	Prompt-to-application systems	Web applications	Minimal	CRM
49	E-commerce	Shopify	E-commerce application platform	Online stores	No	Fashion store
50	E-commerce	BigCommerce	E-commerce platform	Online stores	No/Low	B2B store
51	E-commerce	WooCommerce	WordPress e-commerce system	Online stores	No/Low	Online shop
52	E-commerce	Ecwid	E-commerce builder	Online stores	No	Small business store
53	Community	Circle	Community platform	Membership/community apps	No	Professional community
54	Community	Mighty Networks	Community platform	Communities/courses	No	Learning community
55	Community	Bettermode	Community platform	Customer communities	No	Product community

56	Learning	Teachable	Course platform	Online courses	No	Programming course
57	Learning	Thinkific	Course platform	LMS/course websites	No	Training portal
58	Learning	Kajabi	Business/education platform	Courses, websites, marketing	No	Coaching platform
59	Survey/data	SurveyMonkey	Survey platform	Surveys/data collection	No	Customer research
60	Project management	Monday.com	Work-management platform	Workflow applications	No/Low	Project management
61	Project management	ClickUp	Work-management platform	Custom workflows/apps	No/Low	Software project tracker
62	Project management	Notion	Workspace/database platform	Wikis, databases, lightweight apps	No	Knowledge system
63	Spreadsheet apps	Smartsheet	Spreadsheet/workflow platform	Business applications	No/Low	Project portfolio
64	Business apps	Quickbase	Low-code application platform	Enterprise applications	Low/No	Operations system
65	Business apps	Knack	Database application builder	CRM, portals, databases	No	Membership system
66	Business apps	DronaHQ	Low-code app platform	Internal/mobile apps	Low/No	Business dashboard

67	Business apps	AppMaster	No-code/low-code development platform	Backend, web/mobile applications	No/Low	Business software
68	Desktop	Superapp	No-code native application builder	Mac/iOS applications	No	Native Mac application
69	Desktop/cross-platform	Xojo	Visual cross-platform development tool	Windows/macOS/Linux apps	Low	Desktop business software
70	Desktop/web	Retool	Business application platform	Desktop-accessible internal apps	Low/No	Operations system
71	Desktop/web	Bubble	Web application platform	Desktop browser applications	No	ERP web application
72	Desktop/PWA	Glide	Progressive web application builder	Desktop/mobile PWAs	No	Company dashboard
73	Game development	GDevelop	No-code game engine	2D/3D games	No	Platform game
74	Game development	Construct	Visual game development platform	2D games	No	Browser game
75	Game development	Buildbox	Visual game development tool	Mobile games	No/Low	Arcade game
76	Game development	GameMaker	Visual/low-code game engine	2D games	Low/No for visual workflows	Indie game
77	3D/game	Unity Visual Scripting	Visual programming system	Games and interactive applications	No/Low	Game mechanics

78	3D/game	Unreal Engine Blueprints	Visual scripting system	Games, simulations, 3D applications	No/Low	Game system
79	IoT	Blynk	IoT application platform	IoT dashboards/apps	No	Smart-home dashboard
80	IoT	Node-RED	Visual flow programming	IoT/API automation	Low/No	Sensor automation
81	AI workflow	Flowise	Visual AI workflow builder	LLM applications	No/Low	AI chatbot
82	AI workflow	Langflow	Visual AI workflow platform	AI agents/RAG applications	Low/No	Document chatbot
83	AI automation	Dify	AI application platform	Chatbots, agents, RAG apps	No/Low	Enterprise chatbot
84	AI automation	Voiceflow	Conversational AI builder	Chat/voice agents	No/Low	Customer-service bot
85	Chatbots	Botpress	Visual chatbot development platform	AI assistants/chatbots	Low/No	Support bot
86	Website/app	Dorik	No-code website builder	Websites	No	Business website
87	Website/app	Carrd	Simple website builder	Landing pages	No	Personal landing page
88	Website/app	Duda	Professional website platform	Agency websites	No/Low	Client websites
89	Website/app	Bubble	Full-stack visual platform	SaaS/web software	No	CRM

90	Website/app	Wappler	Visual web development tool	Web applications	Low	Business web app
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This list deliberately separates **true application builders** from tools that mainly create websites, forms, automation, databases, or AI workflows. Current 2026 comparisons similarly distinguish platforms such as Bubble, FlutterFlow, Glide, Softr, Retool, Appsmith and WeWeb by their different application targets rather than treating them as interchangeable. ([Resources Rework](#))

3. Best Tools by Application Type

What you want to build	Recommended tools	Difficulty	Typical output
Simple website	Wix, Squarespace, Framer, Carrd	★	Website
Professional marketing website	Webflow, Framer	★ ★	Website
Blog/content website	WordPress, Webflow, Wix	★	Website/CMS
E-commerce website	Shopify, WooCommerce, BigCommerce	★ ★	Online store
Simple web application	Glide, Softr, Adalo	★	Web app
Complex web application	Bubble, WeWeb	★ ★ ★ ★	Web application
SaaS application	Bubble, WeWeb + Xano	★ ★ ★ ★	SaaS
Customer portal	Softr, Bubble, WeWeb	★ ★ – ★ ★ ★ ★	Portal
Internal company application	Retool, Appsmith, Budibase, ToolJet	★ ★ – ★ ★ ★	Internal app
Admin dashboard	Retool, Appsmith, ToolJet	★ ★	Dashboard

Spreadsheet → application	Glide, AppSheet, Softr	★	Business app
Google Workspace application	AppSheet	★	Business app
Microsoft business application	Power Apps	★ ★	Enterprise app
CRM	Bubble, Airtable, Zoho Creator, Retool	★ ★ – ★ ★ ★ ★	CRM
Inventory system	Glide, AppSheet, Airtable, Bubble	★ ★	Inventory app
HR system	Power Apps, Zoho Creator, Bubble	★ ★ – ★ ★ ★ ★	HR application
Mobile Android app	FlutterFlow, Adalo, Thunkable	★ ★ – ★ ★ ★	Android
Mobile iOS app	FlutterFlow, Adalo, Thunkable	★ ★ – ★ ★ ★	iOS
Cross-platform mobile app	FlutterFlow	★ ★ ★	Android/iOS/Web
Native mobile application	FlutterFlow, Adalo, GoodBarber	★ ★ – ★ ★ ★	Mobile app
Desktop application	Xojo, Superapp, selected FlutterFlow workflows	★ ★ ★	Desktop
Mac application	Superapp, Xojo	★ ★ – ★ ★ ★	macOS
Windows application	Xojo and specialized desktop tools	★ ★ ★	Windows
Linux desktop software	Xojo / specialized frameworks	★ ★ ★	Linux
PWA	Glide, Bubble, Softr, Webflow-based solutions	★ – ★ ★ ★	Progressive Web App
Game	GDevelop, Construct, Buildbox	★ ★	Game
3D application	Unreal Blueprints, Unity Visual Scripting	★ ★ ★	3D software
IoT application	Blynk, Node-RED	★ ★	IoT app

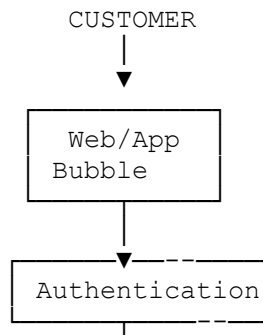
AI chatbot	Voiceflow, Botpress, Dify	★-★ ★ ★	AI chatbot
AI agent	Dify, Flowise, Langflow, Voiceflow	★ ★ - ★ ★ ★	AI agent
AI SaaS	Bubble, Lovable, Bolt, Base44	★ ★ - ★ ★ ★ ★	AI web application
API/backend	Xano, Backendless, Supabase	★ ★ - ★ ★ ★	Backend
Workflow automation	Zapier, Make, n8n	★	Automation
Database application	Airtable, Baserow, NocoDB, Knack	★	Data application

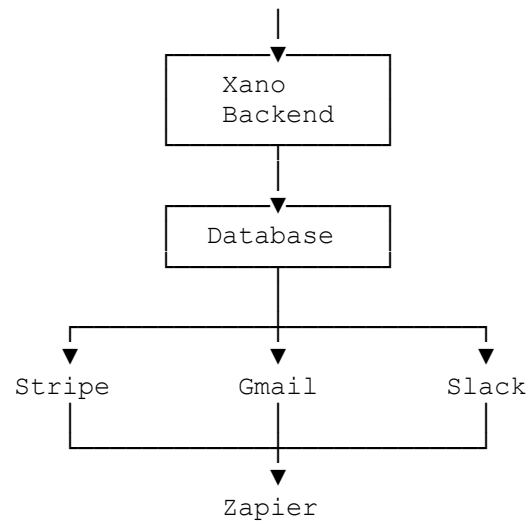
4. Full No-Code Development Stack

One of the most important concepts is that you **do not necessarily need one tool**.

A complete application can be assembled from multiple no-code platforms.

Example: Customer Management SaaS





For example:

Layer	No-code tool
UI	Bubble
Authentication	Bubble/Xano
Backend	Xano
Database	Xano
Payments	Stripe
Automation	Zapier/Make
Email	Gmail/SendGrid

Analytics	Google Analytics
AI	OpenAI/AI platform
Hosting	Platform-managed
Monitoring	Third-party monitoring

This approach is often called a **composable application architecture**.

5. Website vs Web App vs Mobile App vs Desktop App

This distinction is extremely important.

Type	Definition	Example	Suitable no-code tools
Website	Primarily presents information	Company website	Webflow, Wix, Framer
Web application	Software accessed through browser	Gmail-like application	Bubble, WeWeb
PWA	Web application with app-like capabilities	Installable business app	Glide, Bubble
Mobile application	Software designed for phones/tablets	Banking app	FlutterFlow, Adalo
Native mobile app	Built specifically for Android/iOS platform	iPhone banking app	FlutterFlow, Adalo
Desktop application	Software installed on computer	Accounting software	Xojo, specialized desktop builders
SaaS	Software delivered as an online service	Salesforce-like product	Bubble, WeWeb + Xano
Internal application	Software used within an organization	HR dashboard	Retool, Appsmith

AI application	Software incorporating AI workflows	AI document assistant	Dify, Flowise, Bubble
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This distinction matters because many platforms advertise themselves as "app builders" even though their output is actually a **web application or PWA rather than a traditional native desktop/mobile application**. ([Roy Digital App Studio](#))

6. Best Tools for Web Applications

□ Complex SaaS / Web Software

Bubble

Best suited to:

- SaaS
- marketplaces
- CRM
- ERP-like applications
- dashboards
- membership applications
- booking systems
- multi-user applications
- database-driven applications

Bubble is frequently identified as one of the strongest general-purpose no-code platforms for complex web applications. ([Resources Rework](#))

Example

Customer
↓
Login
↓

Dashboard
↓
Products
↓
Shopping Cart
↓
Payment
↓
Order Database
↓
Admin Dashboard

Bubble can model much of this visually.

7. Best Tools for Mobile Applications

FlutterFlow

Particularly useful when you want:

Android
+
iOS
+
Web

and want greater control than typical spreadsheet-based app builders.

A major advantage is that FlutterFlow supports code export, which can matter when you eventually need greater technical control.
([Iotform](#))

Adalo

Good for:

- prototypes
- business apps
- simple mobile applications
- directories
- booking applications

Thunkable

Particularly approachable for:

- education
- beginners
- simple mobile applications
- visual/block-based development.

8. Best Tools for Internal Business Applications

If your company already has databases/APIs and you need:

Employee



Login



Dashboard



Database



Create / Read / Update / Delete



Reports

consider:

Tool	Strength
Retool	Internal business applications
Appsmith	Open-source internal tools
Budibase	Open-source business apps
ToolJet	Internal applications
Power Apps	Microsoft ecosystem
AppSheet	Google ecosystem
Zoho Creator	Business applications

Retool, Appsmith, Budibase and ToolJet are particularly oriented toward internal tools and database/API-connected applications.
([Toolradar](#))

9. Best Tools for AI-Based Software

This is one of the fastest-growing categories.

Instead of:

Drag button

↓

Configure field

↓

Configure workflow

↓
Configure database

you can increasingly describe the application:

"Create an employee management system with login, employee profiles, attendance, leave management, reports and an administrator dashboard."

AI application builders can then generate much of the initial application.

Examples include:

Tool	Main purpose
Lovable	AI-generated web applications
Bolt.new	AI-assisted application development
Replit	AI-assisted software development
Base44	Prompt-driven application creation
v0	AI-generated web interfaces
Dify	AI applications/workflows
Flowise	Visual LLM workflows
Langflow	AI/LLM workflows
Voiceflow	Conversational AI
Botpress	AI agents/chatbots

However, **AI-generated software is not necessarily truly no-code**. Some platforms generate code behind the scenes, and understanding the generated architecture becomes important for production systems. ([Locus Founder](#))

10. Tools for Standalone/Desktop Applications

This category requires special attention.

A website running in Chrome is **not the same thing** as a native desktop application.

For example:

Web application
↓
Chrome / Edge / Firefox
↓
Browser

versus:

Desktop application
↓
.exe / .app / native executable
↓
Windows / macOS / Linux

Traditional no-code desktop development has fewer choices than web/mobile development.

Tool	Desktop capability	Notes
Xojo	Strong	Cross-platform desktop development
Superapp	Native Mac-oriented	No-code native approach

FlutterFlow	Cross-platform desktop possibilities	More low-code when advanced customization is required
Bubble	Browser/PWA	Not a traditional native desktop executable
Glide	PWA	Not traditional native desktop
Retool	Web/internal application	Not native desktop
Softr	Web/PWA	Not native desktop

Current comparisons emphasize this distinction: many platforms described as "desktop app builders" actually produce browser applications or PWAs rather than native Windows/macOS executables. ([Adalo](#))

11. No-Code Database Tools

A large application needs somewhere to store data.

Tool	Type	Example
Airtable	No-code database	CRM
Baserow	Open-source database	Inventory
NocoDB	Database UI	ERP data
Xano	Backend/database	SaaS
Supabase	Backend/database	Web application
Firebase	Backend platform	Mobile app

Backendless	Backend platform	Mobile/web app
Knack	Database application builder	Membership database

For example:

```

Customer
├── ID
├── Name
├── Email
├── Phone
├── Address
└── Orders

```

A no-code database lets you create this structure visually rather than writing SQL manually.

12. No-Code Automation Tools

These tools don't necessarily create the main application UI, but they connect applications together.

Example

```

Customer submits form
↓
Jotform
↓
Zapier
↓
Create CRM record
↓
Send email
↓

```

Send Slack notification



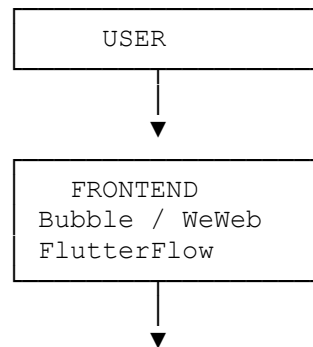
Create task

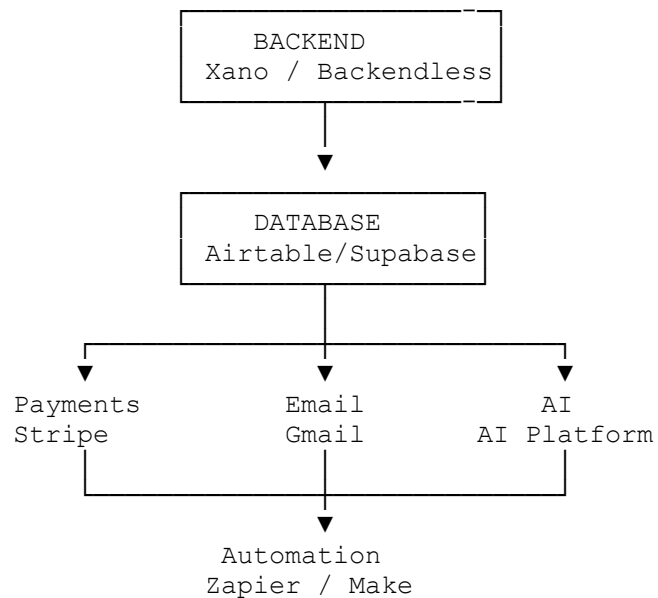
Popular tools:

Tool	Best for
Zapier	Easy automation
Make	Complex visual workflows
n8n	Flexible/open-source workflows
Power Automate	Microsoft ecosystem
Pipedream	API/developer-oriented workflows

13. How the Tools Fit Together

A modern no-code application can look like this:





14. No-Code vs Low-Code vs Pro-Code

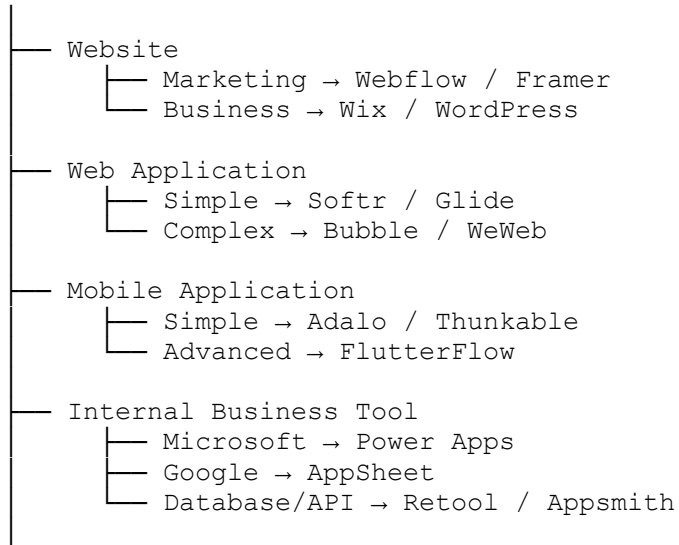
Characteristic	No-Code	Low-Code	Pro-Code
Programming	None/minimal	Some	Extensive
UI	Visual	Visual + code	Code
Logic	Visual	Visual + code	Code
Database	Visual	Visual + SQL	SQL/code
Flexibility	Medium	High	Very high
Development speed	Very high	High	Medium

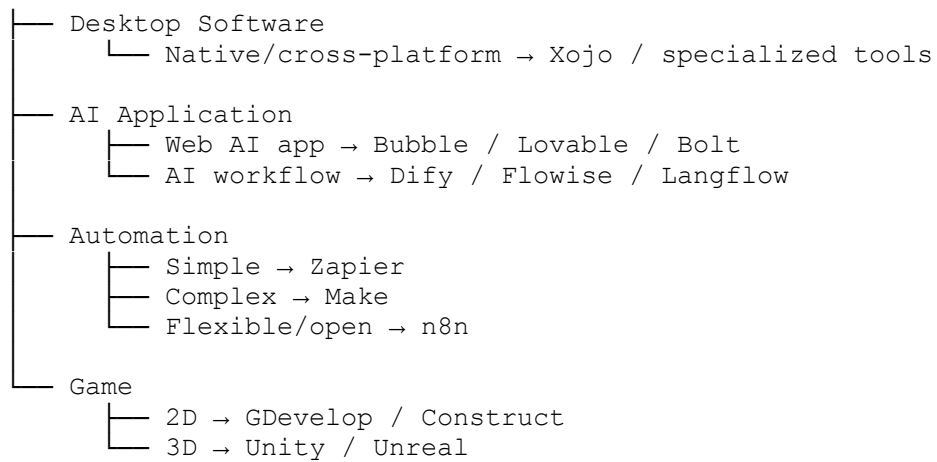
Technical knowledge	Low	Medium	High
Customization	Limited-high depending on platform	High	Very high
Scalability	Depends on platform	Generally high	Highest control
Vendor dependency	Often high	Medium/high	Lower
Code ownership	Often limited	Often better	Full
Best for	Rapid applications	Business software	Complex software

15. Which Tool Should You Choose?

A practical decision tree is:

What do you want to build?





16. My Recommended Shortlist

If your goal is to learn **how software is actually constructed**, rather than simply making a website, I would start with these:

Priority	Tool	Learn it for
1	Bubble	Full-stack web applications
2	FlutterFlow	Mobile applications
3	Retool	Enterprise/internal applications
4	AppSheet	Spreadsheet/data-driven applications
5	Power Apps	Microsoft enterprise applications
6	Glide	Very fast business applications
7	WeWeb	Advanced frontend applications

8	Xano	No-code backend architecture
9	Airtable	No-code databases
10	Make	Business automation
11	n8n	Advanced automation
12	Dify	AI applications
13	Webflow	Professional websites
14	Lovable	AI-generated web applications
15	GDevelop	No-code game development

The most important point

Don't try to learn 100 tools individually.

Instead, learn the **software-development concepts** behind them:

Requirement



UI/UX



Frontend



Backend

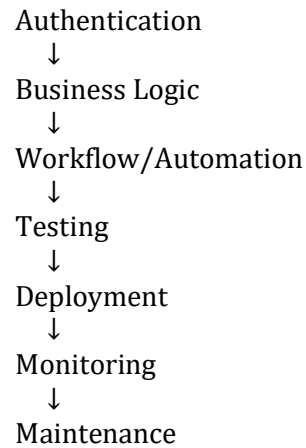


API



Database





Once you understand this architecture, moving from **Bubble → FlutterFlow → Power Apps → Retool → AppSheet → traditional Java/Spring/React development** becomes much easier because the underlying concepts remain similar.

Current 2026 comparisons also reinforce this approach: there is no single "best" no-code platform; Bubble tends to fit complex web software, FlutterFlow native mobile, Glide spreadsheet-driven applications, Softr portals, and Retool internal tools. ([Resources Rework](#))

Absolutely. Below is a **categorized master list of drag-and-drop / visual, no-code and low-code tools**. “All” cannot literally mean every tool worldwide because new products appear frequently, but this covers the major and widely used categories and distinguishes **true drag-and-drop app builders** from website builders, internal-tool builders, mobile builders, desktop tools, game engines, and visual workflow platforms.

What “drag-and-drop development” means

Drag-and-drop development is a visual development approach in which you construct software by selecting components and placing/configuring them visually instead of manually writing the application's UI and much of its logic.

For example:

Traditional development

HTML/CSS/JavaScript



React



API



Database



Deployment

versus:

Drag-and-drop development

Drag Button



Drag Text Box



Drag Table



Connect Database

↓
Create Visual Workflow
↓
Publish

A tool may be **no-code**, **low-code**, or somewhere between the two.

1. Complete Categorized List

#	Category	Website / Tool	Definition	What can be created	Drag & Drop	Coding
1	Web App	Bubble	Visual full-stack application builder	SaaS, CRM, marketplace, portals	✓	No/Low
2	Web App	WeWeb	Visual frontend/application builder	SaaS, dashboards, portals	✓	No/Low
3	Web App	Softr	No-code application and portal builder	Portals, directories, CRM apps	✓	No
4	Web App	Glide	Visual data-driven application builder	Business apps, PWAs	✓	No
5	Web App	Adalo	Visual app-development platform	Web/mobile apps	✓	No/Low
6	Web App	Wappler	Visual web-development environment	Dynamic web applications	✓	Low
7	Web App	Knack	Database-driven application builder	Business apps, portals	✓	No

8	Web App	AppMaster	Visual no-code/low-code development platform	Backend, web/mobile apps	✓	Low
9	Web App	DronaHQ	Visual application development platform	Internal/business apps	✓	Low
10	Web App	Betty Blocks	Enterprise no-code application platform	Business applications	✓	No/Low
11	Web App	Quickbase	Low-code business application platform	Enterprise applications	✓	Low
12	Web App	Mendix	Enterprise low-code platform	Enterprise software	✓	Low
13	Web App	OutSystems	Enterprise low-code development platform	Enterprise web/mobile software	✓	Low
14	Web App	Creatio	No-code business application platform	CRM/workflows	✓	No/Low
15	Web App	Zoho Creator	Low-code business app builder	CRM, HR, inventory	✓	Low
16	Web App	AppSheet	No-code application builder	Business/mobile apps	✓	No
17	Web App	Microsoft Power Apps	Microsoft's visual application platform	Enterprise business apps	✓	Low/No
18	Web App	Oracle APEX	Low-code web application platform	Database applications	✓	Low
19	Web App	Retool	Visual internal application builder	Admin panels, dashboards	✓	Low

20	Web App	Appsmith	Open-source visual internal-tool builder	Dashboards, CRUD apps	✓	Low
21	Web App	Budibase	Open-source low-code platform	Business applications	✓	Low
22	Web App	ToolJet	Visual internal application builder	Admin/operations apps	✓	Low
23	Web App	UI Bakery	Visual business application builder	Internal tools	✓	Low
24	Web App	Superblocks	Enterprise internal-tool builder	Internal applications	✓	Low
25	Website	Webflow	Visual website/CMS builder	Professional websites	✓	No/Low
26	Website	Framer	Visual website builder	Marketing sites, portfolios	✓	No/Low
27	Website	Wix	Visual website platform	Websites, stores, booking sites	✓	No
28	Website	Squarespace	Website builder/CMS	Business websites	✓	No
29	Website	Duda	Professional visual website builder	Agency/client websites	✓	No/Low
30	Website	Dorik	No-code website builder	Websites, landing pages	✓	No
31	Website	Carrd	Lightweight visual site builder	Landing pages	✓	No
32	Website	Elementor	WordPress visual page builder	Websites	✓	No/Low

33	Website	Divi	WordPress visual builder	Websites	✓	No
34	Website	Brizy	Visual WordPress/web builder	Websites	✓	No
35	Website	Oxygen	Visual WordPress builder	Websites	✓	Low
36	Website	Beaver Builder	WordPress drag-and-drop builder	Websites	✓	No/Low
37	E-commerce	Shopify	E-commerce platform with visual customization	Online stores	✓	No/Low
38	E-commerce	BigCommerce	E-commerce platform	Online stores	✓	No/Low
39	E-commerce	WooCommerce	WordPress e-commerce platform	Online stores	✓	No/Low
40	E-commerce	Ecwid	E-commerce builder	Online stores	✓	No
41	E-commerce	Squarespace Commerce	Visual e-commerce system	Online stores	✓	No
42	Mobile	FlutterFlow	Visual application builder	Android/iOS/web apps	✓	Low/No
43	Mobile	Thunkable	Visual mobile app builder	Android/iOS apps	✓	No
44	Mobile	GoodBarber	No-code mobile app builder	iOS/Android apps	✓	No
45	Mobile	BuildFire	Visual mobile application platform	Business apps	✓	No
46	Mobile	Bravo Studio	Design-to-mobile-app platform	Mobile applications	✓	No/Low
47	Mobile	Draftbit	Visual React Native builder	Mobile apps	✓	Low

48	Mobile	AppGyver	Visual application development	Mobile/web apps	✓	Low
49	Mobile	MIT App Inventor	Block-based visual development environment	Android apps	✓	No
50	Mobile	Kodular	Block-based Android builder	Android apps	✓	No
51	Mobile	Niotron	Visual Android app builder	Android apps	✓	No
52	Mobile	App Inventor derivatives	Block-based mobile builders	Android applications	✓	No
53	Desktop	Xojo	Visual cross-platform development environment	Windows/macOS/Linux software	✓	Low
54	Desktop	Superapp	Visual native application builder	Mac/iOS applications	✓	No/Low
55	Desktop	FileMaker	Visual database application platform	Business/desktop apps	✓	Low/No
56	Desktop	Microsoft Access	Visual database application environment	Desktop database applications	✓	Low/No
57	Desktop	LibreOffice Base	Visual database application tool	Database applications	✓	No/Low
58	Desktop	B4X	Visual development ecosystem	Desktop/mobile software	Partly	Low
59	Database	Airtable	Spreadsheet/database hybrid	Databases, business apps	✓	No
60	Database	Baserow	Visual database platform	Databases/apps	✓	No

61	Database	NocoDB	Visual database interface	Database applications	✓	No
62	Database	Stackby	Spreadsheet/database platform	Business databases	✓	No
63	Database	SeaTable	Visual database platform	Business databases/apps	✓	No
64	Database	Directus	Data platform with visual administration	Data-driven applications	✓	Low
65	Backend	Xano	Visual backend/API platform	APIs, databases, backend logic	✓	No/Low
66	Backend	Backendless	Backend-as-a-service platform	Mobile/web backends	✓	Low/No
67	Backend	Supabase	Backend platform with visual database tools	APIs, authentication, database	Partly	Low
68	Backend	Firebase	Backend development platform	Mobile/web backends	Partly	Low
69	Backend	Parse	Backend platform	APIs/database backends	Partly	Low
70	Automation	Zapier	Visual workflow automation platform	Automated workflows	✓	No
71	Automation	Make	Visual automation platform	Complex integrations	✓	No/Low
72	Automation	n8n	Visual workflow automation platform	API/AI/data workflows	✓	Low/No
73	Automation	Power Automate	Microsoft's workflow platform	Enterprise automation	✓	No/Low

74	Automation	Pipedream	Workflow/API automation platform	API workflows	✓	Low
75	Automation	Workato	Enterprise automation platform	Business automation	✓	Low
76	Automation	Tray.io	Integration automation platform	Enterprise workflows	✓	Low
77	AI App	Lovable	AI-assisted visual application builder	Web apps/SaaS	Partly	Minimal
78	AI App	Bolt.new	AI application-development environment	Web apps	Partly	Minimal
79	AI App	Replit	AI-assisted application development platform	Websites/apps/software	Partly	Low
80	AI App	Base44	Prompt-driven application builder	Business/web apps	Partly	Minimal
81	AI App	v0	AI UI/application generator	Web interfaces/apps	Partly	Low
82	AI	Dify	Visual AI application platform	AI apps, agents, RAG	✓	No/Low
83	AI	Flowise	Visual LLM workflow builder	AI agents/RAG	✓	No/Low
84	AI	Langflow	Visual AI workflow builder	LLM applications	✓	Low/No
85	AI	Voiceflow	Visual conversational-AI builder	Chat/voice agents	✓	No/Low
86	AI	Botpress	Visual chatbot/agent platform	AI assistants	✓	Low/No
87	Game	GDevelop	No-code/visual game engine	2D/3D games	✓	No

88	Game	Construct	Visual game engine	2D games	✓	No/Low
89	Game	Buildbox	Visual game-development platform	Mobile games	✓	No/Low
90	Game	GameMaker	Visual/low-code game engine	2D games	✓	Low
91	Game	Unity Visual Scripting	Node-based visual programming	Games/3D apps	✓	No/Low
92	Game	Unreal Engine Blueprints	Node-based visual programming	Games/3D applications	✓	No/Low
93	IoT	Blynk	Visual IoT application platform	IoT dashboards/apps	✓	No
94	IoT	Node-RED	Visual flow programming platform	IoT/API systems	✓	Low/No
95	Forms	Jotform	Visual form/application builder	Forms, workflows, simple apps	✓	No
96	Forms	Typeform	Interactive form builder	Surveys/applications	✓	No
97	Forms	Fillout	Advanced visual form builder	Forms/workflows	✓	No
98	Forms	Formstack	Form/workflow platform	Business forms/apps	✓	No/Low
99	Community	Circle	Visual community platform	Member communities	✓	No
100	Community	Mighty Networks	Community/course platform	Online communities	✓	No
101	LMS	Teachable	Course platform	Learning websites	✓	No
102	LMS	Thinkific	Course/LMS platform	Learning applications	✓	No

103	LMS	Kajabi	Education/business platform	Courses, websites	✓	No
104	Project Apps	Monday.com	Visual work-management platform	Business workflows/apps	✓	No/Low
105	Project Apps	ClickUp	Visual productivity/workflow platform	Project/business systems	✓	No/Low
106	Project Apps	Notion	Visual workspace/database platform	Knowledge systems/apps	✓	No
107	Project Apps	Smartsheet	Spreadsheet/workflow platform	Business applications	✓	No/Low
108	CRM	HubSpot	CRM/business platform	CRM, marketing workflows	✓	No/Low
109	CRM	Salesforce Platform	Enterprise low-code platform	CRM/business apps	✓	Low
110	CRM	Zoho CRM/Creator	Business application ecosystem	CRM/business software	✓	No/Low
111	Enterprise	SAP Build Apps	Enterprise visual app builder	Business applications	✓	Low
112	Enterprise	ServiceNow App Engine	Enterprise application platform	IT/business apps	✓	Low
113	Enterprise	Pega	Low-code process/application platform	Enterprise software	✓	Low
114	Enterprise	Appian	Low-code business application platform	Enterprise workflows/apps	✓	Low
115	Enterprise	Mendix	Enterprise low-code platform	Web/mobile/enterprise apps	✓	Low

116	Enterprise	OutSystems	Enterprise low-code platform	Enterprise applications	✓	Low
117	3D	Unity	Visual/low-code game/3D platform	Games, simulations	✓	Low
118	3D	Unreal Engine	Visual 3D/game platform	Games, simulations	✓	Low
119	3D	Godot	Open-source game engine	Games/interactive software	Partly	Low
120	Prototyping	Figma	Collaborative visual UI design platform	UI prototypes/designs	✓	No
121	Prototyping	Penpot	Open-source design/prototyping platform	UI/UX prototypes	✓	No
122	Prototyping	Axure RP	Advanced interaction prototyping tool	Software prototypes	✓	No/Low
123	Prototyping	Balsamiq	Wireframe/prototype tool	UI wireframes	✓	No
124	Prototyping	ProtoPie	Interactive prototype platform	High-fidelity interactions	✓	No/Low

2. The Most Important Categories

The table above contains many different types of tools. They should **not** all be treated as equivalent.

A. Drag-and-Drop Website Builders

These primarily create websites.

Tool	Best use	Example
Webflow	Professional websites	Corporate website
Framer	Modern marketing websites	Startup landing page
Wix	General websites	Small-business website
Squarespace	Business/portfolio	Photographer website
Carrd	Simple landing pages	Personal profile
Elementor	WordPress sites	Company website
Divi	WordPress websites	Agency website
Duda	Agency websites	Client websites

Example

Drag:
 [Header]
 [Logo]
 [Navigation]
 [Hero]
 [Image]
 [Text]
 [Button]
 [Footer]

You arrange these visually and configure their properties.

Important: A website builder is not necessarily a full software/application builder.

3. Drag-and-Drop Web Application Builders

These are much closer to traditional software development.

Bubble

A typical application might contain:

Login



Dashboard

- └─ Customers
- └─ Products
- └─ Orders
- └─ Reports
- └─ Settings

You visually create:

- pages
- buttons
- forms
- workflows
- database entities
- conditions
- authentication
- API integrations
- reusable components.

WeWeb

Strong for visually creating application frontends and connecting them to backend/data services.

Softr

Particularly useful for:

- portals
- directories
- membership applications
- internal applications
- database-driven websites.

Glide

Excellent when your application begins with structured data such as:

Google Sheets



Glide



Mobile/Web App

4. Drag-and-Drop Mobile Application Builders

Tool	Android	iOS	Web	Beginner-friendly
FlutterFlow	✓	✓	✓	★ ★ ★
Adalo	✓	✓	✓	★ ★ ★ ★ ★
Thunkable	✓	✓	✓	★ ★ ★ ★ ★
GoodBarber	✓	✓	—	★ ★ ★ ★
BuildFire	✓	✓	—	★ ★ ★ ★

Draftbit	✓	✓	—	★ ★ ★
MIT App Inventor	✓	Limited	—	★ ★ ★ ★ ★
Kodular	✓	—	—	★ ★ ★ ★ ★

Example: Mobile shopping application

Home
 ↓
 Products
 ↓
 Product Details
 ↓
 Add to Cart
 ↓
 Checkout
 ↓
 Payment
 ↓
 Order Confirmation

This can be constructed visually in appropriate mobile builders.

5. Drag-and-Drop Standalone/Desktop Software

This category is more limited.

A **standalone application** generally means software that can run independently on an operating system rather than only inside a browser.

Examples:

Windows



MyApplication.exe

or:

macOS



MyApplication.app

or:

Linux



MyApplication

Useful tools

Tool	Windows	macOS	Linux	Best use
Xojo	✓	✓	✓	Cross-platform desktop software
FileMaker	✓	✓	—	Database/business applications
Microsoft Access	✓	—	—	Database applications
LibreOffice Base	✓	✓	✓	Database applications
Superapp	—	✓	—	Native Mac-oriented applications

Important: Bubble, Glide, Softr and many other "app builders" primarily produce **web applications/PWAs**, not traditional .exe or .app desktop programs.

6. Drag-and-Drop Enterprise Application Development

If you're working in a company, these become particularly important:

Platform	Typical application
Microsoft Power Apps	HR system
AppSheet	Field-service application
Zoho Creator	CRM/inventory system
Retool	Admin dashboard
Appsmith	Internal operations application
Budibase	Internal business application
Mendix	Enterprise software
OutSystems	Large enterprise applications
Appian	Business process application
Pega	Workflow/enterprise applications
ServiceNow App Engine	IT/business applications
SAP Build Apps	SAP/enterprise applications
Oracle APEX	Database-driven applications

7. Drag-and-Drop Database/Application Builders

These are particularly useful because applications need data.

For example:

CUSTOMER

Customer ID

Name

Email

Phone

ORDER

Order ID

Customer ID

Date

Amount

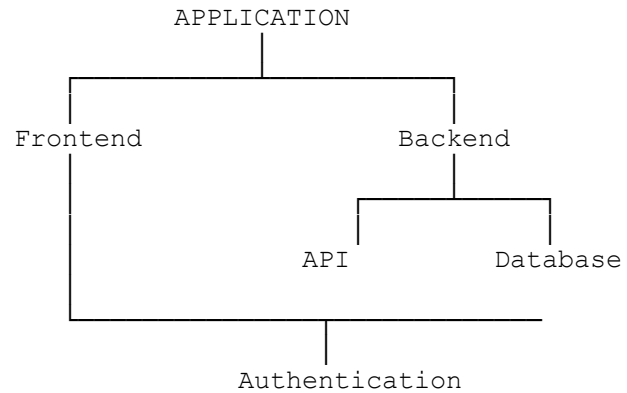
Status

You can visually create these structures in platforms such as:

- Airtable
 - Baserow
 - NocoDB
 - Knack
 - FileMaker
 - AppSheet
 - Zoho Creator.
-

8. Drag-and-Drop Backend Builders

A modern application has more than a UI.



Tools such as **Xano**, **Backendless**, **Supabase**, and **Firebase** can provide various pieces of this backend architecture.

9. Drag-and-Drop Automation

Automation is different from application development.

For example:

Customer fills form



Jotform



Make



Create CRM record
↓
Send email
↓
Create task
↓
Notify employee

Popular visual automation tools:

Tool	Complexity	Example
Zapier	★	Gmail → Slack
Make	★ ★ ★	CRM → Email → Database → Slack
n8n	★ ★ ★ ★	API/AI workflow
Power Automate	★ ★ ★	Microsoft workflow
Workato	★ ★ ★ ★	Enterprise integration
Tray.io	★ ★ ★ ★	Enterprise automation

10. Drag-and-Drop AI Application Builders

A newer approach is **prompt + visual development**.

For example:

Create an employee management application with login, employee records, attendance, leave management, reports and an administrator dashboard.

AI-assisted tools can generate an initial application structure.

Tool	Main purpose
Lovable	Web application generation
Bolt.new	Application generation
Replit	AI-assisted development
Base44	Prompt-driven application creation
v0	UI/application generation
Bubble + AI	AI-assisted application building
Dify	AI applications
Flowise	AI workflows
Langflow	LLM workflows
Voiceflow	AI conversational applications
Botpress	AI agents

The important distinction is:

AI-assisted ≠ necessarily no-code.

Some AI tools generate actual source code behind the scenes.

11. Drag-and-Drop Game Development

If "software" includes games:

Tool	Best for	Coding
GDevelop	Beginners/2D games	No
Construct	2D games	No/Low
Buildbox	Mobile games	No/Low
GameMaker	2D games	Low
Unity Visual Scripting	2D/3D games	Low/No
Unreal Blueprints	Advanced 3D games	Low/No
Godot	Games	Low/Some

For example:

Player
↓
Collision
↓
Enemy
↓
Health decreases
↓
Health = 0
↓

Game Over

With visual scripting, this can be represented as connected nodes rather than conventional code.

12. Drag-and-Drop IoT Development

For IoT:

Temperature Sensor



IoT Platform



Database



Dashboard



Alert

Useful tools include:

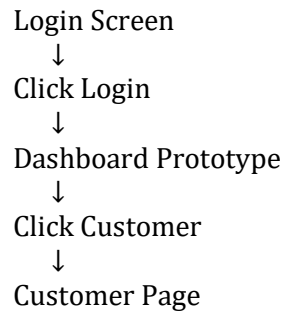
- Blynk
 - Node-RED
 - selected AppSheet/Power Apps workflows
 - cloud IoT platforms with visual workflow capabilities.
-

13. Drag-and-Drop UI/UX Prototyping

Tools such as **Figma**, **Penpot**, **Axure RP**, **Balsamiq** and **ProtoPie** are often confused with application builders.

They primarily create **designs and prototypes**, not necessarily production software.

Example:



This is extremely useful **before** building the actual application.

14. No-Code vs Drag-and-Drop

They are related but not identical.

Concept	Meaning
No-code	Little/no traditional programming
Drag-and-drop	Visual placement of components
Visual programming	Programming using graphical nodes/blocks
Low-code	Mostly visual development plus optional code
AI coding	AI generates code from instructions
Prompt-to-app	Describe an application and AI generates it
WYSIWYG	"What You See Is What You Get" visual editing

RAD	Rapid Application Development
Visual development	Broad category encompassing these approaches

Therefore:

No-Code

- └─ Drag-and-drop
- └─ Visual workflows
- └─ Visual databases
- └─ Configuration

Low-Code

- └─ Drag-and-drop
- └─ Visual workflows
- └─ Generated code
- └─ Custom code

AI Development

- └─ Prompt
- └─ Generated UI
- └─ Generated code
- └─ Human refinement

15. Which Tool Should You Choose?

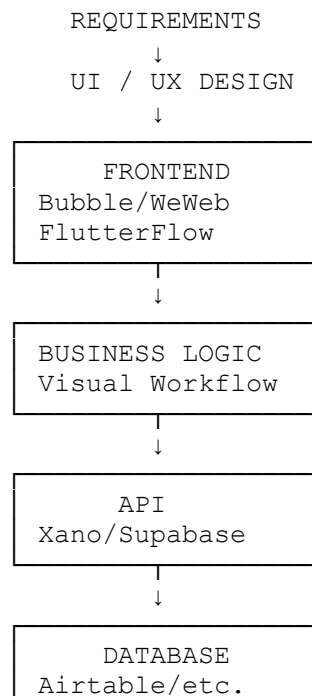
Your objective	First tools to investigate
Simple website	Wix / Framer
Professional website	Webflow

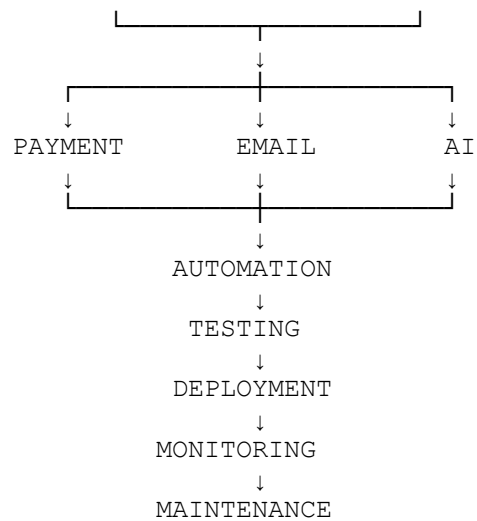
Landing page	Framer / Carrd
WordPress website	Elementor / Divi
Simple business application	Glide / Softr
Complex web application	Bubble / WeWeb
SaaS	Bubble / WeWeb + Xano
Mobile application	FlutterFlow
Beginner Android app	MIT App Inventor / Thunkable
Internal business application	Retool / Appsmith
Microsoft ecosystem	Power Apps
Google ecosystem	AppSheet
Database application	Airtable / Baserow / Knack
Backend	Xano / Backendless
Automation	Zapier / Make / n8n
AI application	Dify / Flowise / Bubble / Lovable
AI chatbot	Voiceflow / Botpress
Desktop software	Xojo / FileMaker
Database desktop software	Microsoft Access / FileMaker
2D game	GDevelop / Construct

3D game	Unreal Blueprints / Unity Visual Scripting
IoT	Blynk / Node-RED
UI prototype	Figma / Penpot / Axure
Enterprise application	Mendix / OutSystems / Power Apps / Appian

16. A Complete Drag-and-Drop Software Development Workflow

If your ultimate goal is to build **complete software without traditional coding**, think in terms of layers:





The key takeaway

If you want to **learn drag-and-drop development systematically**, don't learn the tools alphabetically. Learn them by the **software layer they replace**:

1. UI/UX → 2. Website → 3. Frontend → 4. Business Logic → 5. Backend → 6. API → 7. Database → 8. Authentication → 9. Automation → 10. AI → 11. Testing → 12. Deployment → 13. Monitoring.

That approach also makes it much easier to understand how these visual tools correspond to traditional technologies such as **HTML/CSS/JavaScript, React, Java/Spring Boot, REST APIs, SQL, databases, authentication, Docker and cloud deployment.**

Yes. The key thing to understand is that **not every drag-and-drop/no-code tool can be installed locally**. Some are SaaS websites that run only in the cloud, while others are downloadable desktop applications or open-source projects that you can self-host on your laptop.

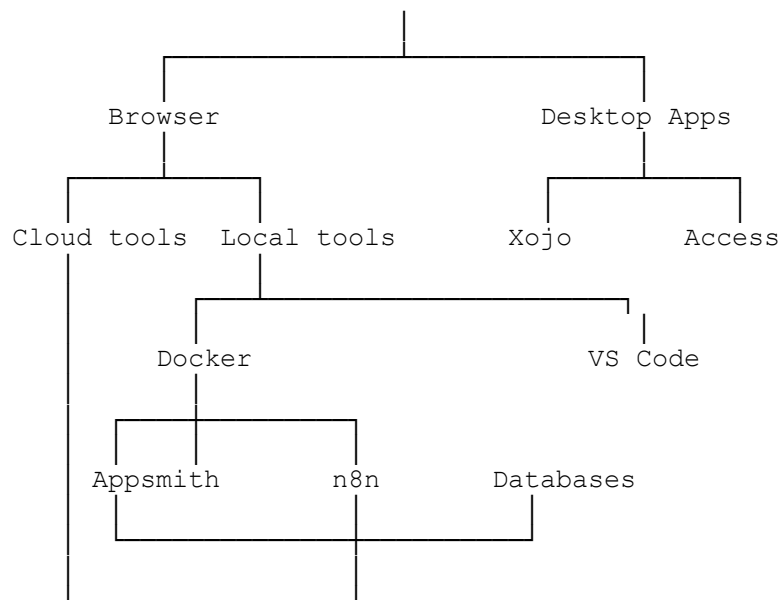
1. What does “set up locally” mean?

Term	Definition	Example
Cloud/SaaS tool	Runs on the vendor's servers; you access it through a browser	Bubble, Webflow
Desktop software	Installed directly on your laptop	Xojo, Microsoft Access
Self-hosted software	You install the server/application yourself	Appsmith, Budibase, n8n
Local development environment	Software installed to build/test applications locally	VS Code, Docker
Local database	Database running on your laptop	PostgreSQL, MySQL
Local web server	Runs an application on localhost	Node.js, Apache, Nginx
Containerized application	Runs inside Docker containers	Appsmith, n8n
Hybrid	Local development with cloud services	FlutterFlow + local tools
PWA	Web application that can behave somewhat like an installed app	Glide-based app
Native application	Compiled for an operating system	Windows .exe, macOS .app

2. First Understand the Architecture

A local no-code development laptop can look like this:

YOUR LAPTOP



3. Recommended Laptop Software Stack

Before installing individual no-code tools, create a basic development environment.

#	Software	Purpose	Local?	Why install it
1	Web Browser	Access cloud builders	✓	Chrome/Edge/Firefox
2	VS Code	Edit configuration/code when needed	✓	Useful even for no-code
3	Git	Version control	✓	Track project changes
4	GitHub Desktop	Visual Git interface	✓	Easier Git management
5	Docker Desktop	Run self-hosted applications	✓	Essential for many open-source tools

6	Node.js	JavaScript runtime	✓	Useful for web tooling
7	Python	Automation/backend utilities	✓	Useful for scripts
8	Java JDK	Java development	✓	Useful if combining no-code with Java
9	PostgreSQL	Relational database	✓	Local application database
10	MySQL	Relational database	✓	Alternative database
11	SQLite	Lightweight database	✓	Excellent for local prototypes
12	Postman	Test APIs	✓	Useful for backend/API testing
13	DBeaver	Database management	✓	Visual database administration

4. Which Drag-and-Drop Tools Can Actually Be Installed Locally?

This is the most important distinction.

Tool/category	Local installation	How you use it locally	Cloud required?
Bubble	✗	Browser	Primarily yes
Webflow	✗	Browser	Yes
Framer	✗ / limited	Browser/desktop access	Primarily yes
Wix	✗	Browser	Yes
Squarespace	✗	Browser	Yes

Soft	✗	Browser	Yes
Glide	✗	Browser	Yes
WeWeb	✗	Browser	Yes
Adalo	✗ / limited	Browser	Primarily yes
FlutterFlow	☐	Browser/local development options	Primarily cloud
Retool	☐	Cloud or self-hosted options depending on plan/product	Depends
Appsmith	✓	Docker/local/self-hosted	No, if self-hosted
Budibase	✓	Docker/self-hosted	No, if self-hosted
ToolJet	✓	Docker/self-hosted	No, if self-hosted
n8n	✓	npm/Docker	No, for local instance
Dify	✓	Docker/self-hosted	No, for local instance
Flowise	✓	npm/Docker	No, for local instance
Langflow	✓	Python/Docker	No, for local instance
Node-RED	✓	npm/Docker	No
GDevelop	✓	Desktop application	No
Construct	☐	Browser/desktop options	Depends
Unity	✓	Desktop application	No for basic local development

Unreal Engine	✓	Desktop application	No for basic development
Xojo	✓	Desktop application	No
Microsoft Access	✓	Windows desktop	No
FileMaker	✓	Desktop/server	Depends on deployment
Airtable	✗	Browser/desktop client	Yes
Baserow	✓	Self-hosted option	No, if self-hosted
NocoDB	✓	Docker/self-hosted	No
Supabase	✓	Self-hosted option	No, if self-hosted
Firebase	✗	Cloud platform	Yes
Xano	✗	Cloud	Yes
Zapier	✗	Browser	Yes
Make	✗	Browser	Yes
n8n	✓	Local/self-hosted	No
Power Apps	✗	Cloud/Microsoft environment	Yes
AppSheet	✗	Cloud	Yes
Zoho Creator	✗	Cloud	Yes
MIT App Inventor	☐	Browser + local companion tools	Primarily browser

Kodular	×	Browser	Yes
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☐ = availability and capabilities can vary by current edition/plan.

5. Step 1 — Install a Browser

For cloud-based no-code tools, your browser is the main development environment.

Browser	Use
Chrome	General-purpose development
Microsoft Edge	Microsoft ecosystem
Firefox	Alternative/testing
Brave	Alternative browser

Create separate browser profiles if you work with many development accounts:

Chrome

└— Personal

└— Development

└— Client A

└— Client B

6. Step 2 — Install VS Code

Visual Studio Code is useful even if you intend to avoid coding.

Why?

Because eventually you may need to inspect:

- JSON
- API responses
- configuration files
- exported application code
- HTML
- CSS
- JavaScript
- environment variables
- Docker files.

A useful structure is:

```
C:\NoCodeProjects\  
|  
├─ WebApps\  
├─ MobileApps\  
├─ DesktopApps\  
├─ AIApps\  
├─ Automation\  
├─ Databases\  
└─ Experiments\
```

On macOS/Linux, use an equivalent folder such as:

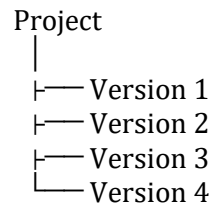
```
~/NoCodeProjects/
```

7. Step 3 — Install Git

Git isn't a no-code application builder.

It is a **version-control system**.

Example:



If something breaks, you can compare or restore earlier versions.

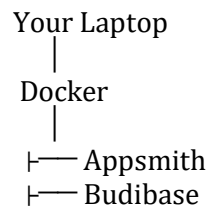
This becomes particularly valuable when a visual builder exports source code or configuration files.

8. Step 4 — Install Docker Desktop

For local no-code development, **Docker is one of the most useful pieces of software you can install**.

Docker allows applications to run in isolated containers.

Conceptually:



- └─ ToolJet
- └─ n8n
- └─ Dify
- └─ Flowise
- └─ NocoDB
- └─ Supabase

Instead of manually installing every dependency, Docker can package the application and its dependencies.

9. Installing Appsmith Locally

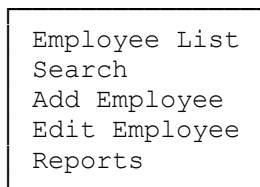
Appsmith is an open-source platform for building internal applications visually.

Example:

Employee Database



Appsmith



A typical local setup is:

Laptop



Docker



Appsmith
↓
Browser
↓
localhost

You can then work with the locally running application through a browser.

10. Installing Budibase Locally

Budibase is another open-source low-code/no-code platform.

Typical architecture:

Browser
↓
localhost
↓
Budibase
↓
Database

Example application:

Inventory Management
├— Products
├— Suppliers
├— Stock
├— Purchases
└— Reports

This is particularly useful for learning how visual application builders connect UI → business logic → data.

11. Installing ToolJet Locally

ToolJet is designed primarily for internal tools.

Example:

```
graph TD;
    A[PostgreSQL] --> B[ToolJet];
    B --> C[Admin Dashboard];
    C --> D[Employee / Customer / Order data];
```

This makes it useful for learning database-driven applications without building the entire frontend manually.

12. Installing n8n Locally

n8n is a visual workflow automation platform.

Example:

```
graph TD;
    A[Form submission] --> B[n8n];
    B --> C[Check database];
    C --> D[Send email];
    D --> E[Create record];
```



Send notification

You can run n8n locally using Docker or other supported local installation methods.

A local workflow might be:

localhost



n8n

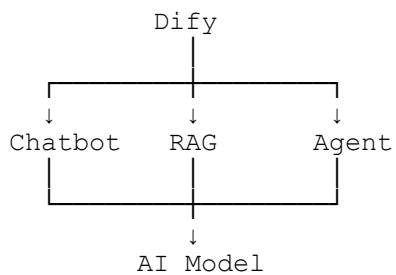


http://localhost:...

13. Installing Dify Locally

Dify is useful for visually creating AI applications.

Example:



You can use it to experiment with:

- AI chat applications
- RAG

- knowledge bases
- AI workflows
- agents
- prompt workflows.

14. Installing Flowise

Flowise uses a visual node-based approach.

Instead of:

write code → test → debug

you can visually connect nodes:

Document
↓
Text Splitter
↓
Embeddings
↓
Vector Database
↓
Retriever
↓
LLM
↓
Answer

This is particularly useful for understanding **AI application architecture visually**.

15. Installing Langflow

Langflow provides another visual approach to AI/LLM application construction.

Example:

Input
↓
Prompt
↓
Model
↓
Memory
↓
Output

It can be run locally using supported Python/Docker installation approaches.

16. Installing Node-RED

Node-RED is a visual flow-development tool.

Example:

Sensor
↓
Node
↓
Condition
↓
Database
↓
Dashboard

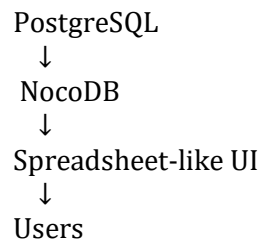
It's especially useful for:

- IoT
- APIs
- automation
- data processing
- event-driven applications.

17. Installing NocoDB

NocoDB turns databases into a spreadsheet-like interface.

For example:



Instead of writing SQL for every operation, users can interact with structured data visually.

18. Local Database Setup

A good local no-code/low-code laptop should have at least one database.

Database	Difficulty	Best for
SQLite	★	Beginners/local prototypes

PostgreSQL	★ ★ ★	Serious application development
MySQL	★ ★	Web applications
MariaDB	★ ★	MySQL-compatible applications
MongoDB	★ ★	Document-oriented applications

For learning application architecture, **PostgreSQL is an excellent general-purpose choice.**

19. Visual Database Management

Install a database GUI such as **DBeaver**.

Instead of:

```
SELECT * FROM employee;
```

you can visually:

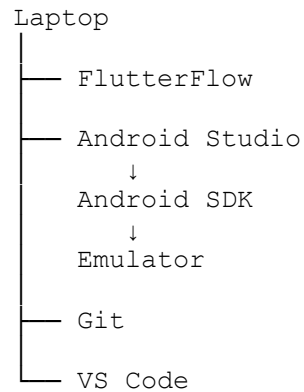
```
Database
↓
Tables
↓
employee
↓
Columns
↓
Rows
```

This is especially helpful for someone learning the relationship between no-code applications and traditional software development.

20. Local Mobile-App Development

For visual mobile development, the setup is different.

A possible environment:



FlutterFlow itself is primarily a visual application-building platform rather than simply a conventional offline desktop drag-and-drop editor, so check its current local/export capabilities before designing an entirely offline workflow.

21. MIT App Inventor / Kodular

For beginners, block-based development is particularly easy to understand.

Example:

WHEN
Button1.Click

DO

set Label1.Text
to "Hello World"

This is effectively programming with visual blocks.

The conceptual equivalent in traditional programming would be an event handler.

22. Local Game Development

For visual/no-code game development:

GDevelop

A typical setup is:

GDevelop



Scene



Objects



Events



Game

Example:

IF

Player collides with Coin

THEN

Score = Score + 1

AND
Destroy Coin

No conventional programming syntax is necessary for many game mechanics.

23. Unity Visual Scripting

Unity can be installed locally.

Instead of writing:

```
if (playerTouchesEnemy) {  
    health--;  
}
```

visual scripting can represent the logic as connected nodes:

```
Collision  
↓  
Is Enemy?  
↓  
YES  
↓  
Decrease Health
```

This is technically closer to **visual programming/low-code** than pure no-code.

24. Unreal Engine Blueprints

Unreal Engine provides **Blueprints**, a node-based visual scripting system.

Example:

Event Begin Play
↓
Set Health
↓
100

and:

Player Damage
↓
Subtract Health
↓
Health <= 0 ?
↓
Game Over

This allows substantial application/game logic without traditional text-based programming.

25. Desktop Application Development

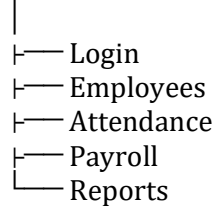
For genuine standalone desktop software, investigate tools such as:

Tool	Operating systems	Approach
Xojo	Windows/macOS/Linux	Visual development
Microsoft Access	Windows	Database/visual application
FileMaker	Windows/macOS	Visual database application
LibreOffice Base	Windows/macOS/Linux	Database application

Unity	Windows/macOS/Linux	Visual/low-code for interactive apps
Unreal Engine	Windows/macOS/Linux	Visual Blueprints

Example desktop software:

Employee Management.exe



26. Cloud Tools Don't Need Local Installation

For these tools, **do not try to install the website itself on your laptop** unless the vendor explicitly provides a self-hosted edition.

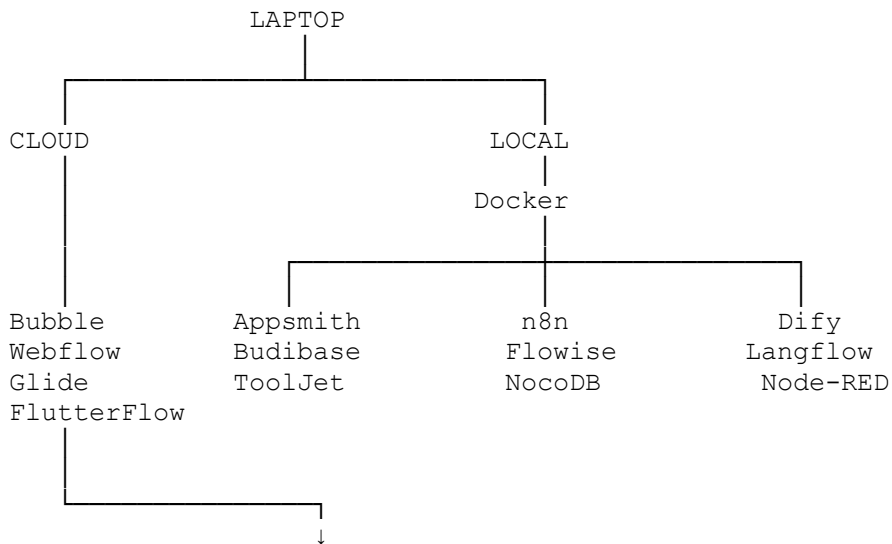
Tool	Typical local setup
Bubble	Create account → use browser
Webflow	Create account → use browser
Wix	Create account → use browser
Softr	Create account → use browser
Glide	Create account → use browser
WeWeb	Create account → use browser

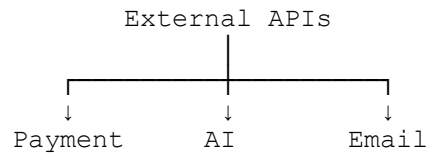
AppSheet	Google account → browser
Power Apps	Microsoft account/tenant → browser
Zapier	Browser
Make	Browser
Xano	Cloud account/browser

Your laptop is simply the **client/development workstation**.

27. Recommended Local Laptop Architecture

If your objective is to learn **as many drag-and-drop technologies as possible**, I recommend this architecture:





28. Suggested Installation Order

Don't install everything simultaneously.

Phase	Install	Purpose
1	Chrome/Edge/Firefox	Cloud development
2	VS Code	General development
3	Git	Version control
4	GitHub Desktop	Easier Git management
5	Docker Desktop	Local/self-hosted apps
6	PostgreSQL	Database
7	DBeaver	Database GUI
8	Postman	API testing
9	n8n	Visual automation
10	Appsmith	Visual business applications
11	Budibase	No-code/low-code applications

12	NocoDB	Visual database
13	Dify	AI applications
14	Flowise	Visual AI workflows
15	Langflow	LLM workflows
16	Node-RED	Visual automation/IoT
17	GDevelop	Visual game development
18	Xojo	Desktop applications
19	Android Studio	Mobile testing
20	Unity/Unreal	Advanced visual development

29. Example: Build a Local Employee Management System

Suppose you want to build:

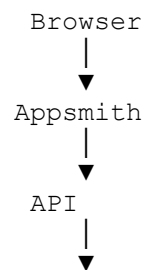
Employee Management System

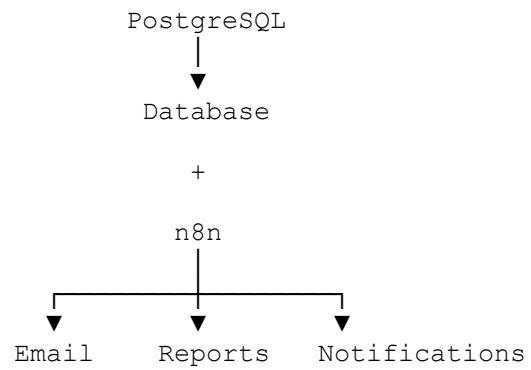
- |
- ├— Login
- ├— Dashboard
- ├— Employees
- ├— Attendance
- ├— Leave
- ├— Departments
- └— Reports

A completely local learning stack could be:

Layer	Tool
UI	Appsmith
Visual logic	Appsmith
Database	PostgreSQL
Database GUI	DBeaver
Automation	n8n
API	Local REST service
Testing	Postman
Containers	Docker
Version control	Git
Editor	VS Code

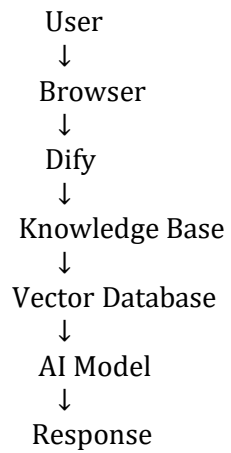
Architecture:





You could build much of the system visually.

30. Example: Local AI Application



Possible local components:

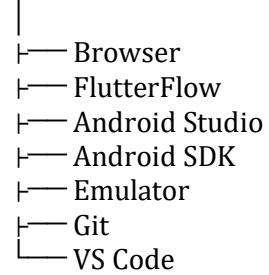
Component	Tool
AI application	Dify
Visual workflow	Flowise/Langflow
Database	PostgreSQL
Automation	n8n
Containers	Docker
API testing	Postman
Editor	VS Code

31. Example: Local Mobile Application

FlutterFlow
↓
Mobile UI
↓
API
↓
Database
↓
Authentication
↓
Android/iOS

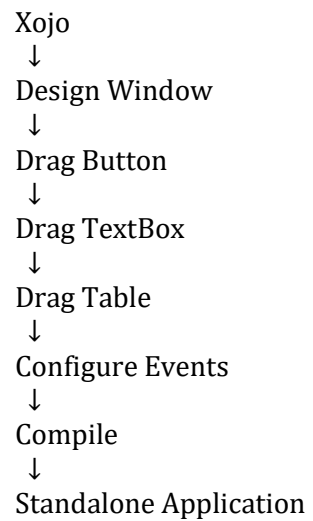
Laptop:

Laptop



32. Example: Local Desktop Software

For a desktop application:



Result:

Windows → .exe
macOS → .app
Linux → executable

The exact output formats and platform support depend on the tool and edition.

33. Cloud vs Local: Final Comparison

Feature	Cloud no-code	Self-hosted no-code	Desktop visual software
Internet needed	Usually	Not necessarily	No
Installation	Minimal	Required	Required
Drag & drop	✓	✓	✓
Local database	Usually no	✓	✓
Full offline operation	✗/limited	✓	✓
Vendor controls hosting	Usually	No	No
Maintenance	Low	You manage it	You manage it
Customization	Platform-dependent	High	High
Best for	Fast production apps	Learning/control	Standalone software
Example	Bubble	Appsmith	Xojo

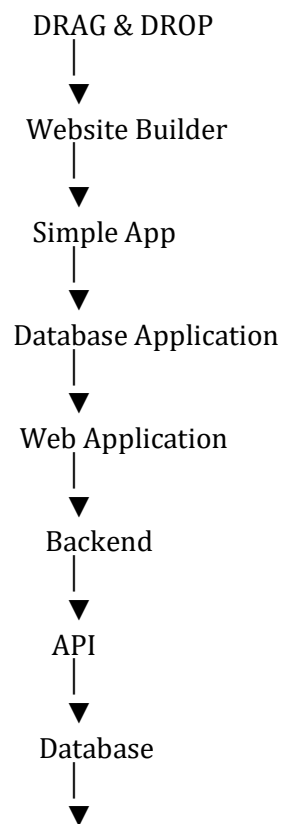
34. Recommended Laptop Setup for You

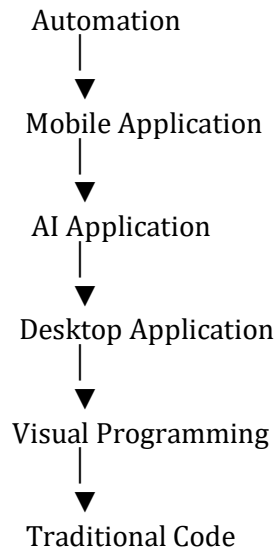
If your goal is specifically to **learn drag-and-drop development from beginner to professional**, I would use this stack:

Layer	Recommended starting tool	Why
Website	Webflow	Learn visual web design
Simple app	Glide	Understand data-driven apps
Complex web app	Bubble	Learn visual full-stack concepts
Mobile	FlutterFlow	Learn cross-platform apps
Internal app	Appsmith	Learn database-driven software
Database	PostgreSQL	Learn real database concepts
Database GUI	DBeaver	Visual database management
Backend	Xano / Supabase	Understand backend architecture
Automation	n8n	Visual workflows
AI	Dify	Visual AI applications
AI workflow	Flowise	Node-based AI architecture
IoT	Node-RED	Event/flow-based programming
Games	GDevelop	No-code game development
Advanced games/3D	Unreal Blueprints	Visual programming
Desktop	Xojo	Standalone applications

API testing	Postman	Understand APIs
Containers	Docker Desktop	Run local services
Version control	Git	Manage projects
Editor	VS Code	Inspect/customize projects

The ideal learning progression





This last transition is especially valuable: learning no-code/drag-and-drop tools does not have to be an alternative to programming. It can be a way to understand **UI, components, events, workflows, business logic, APIs, databases, authentication, deployment, and architecture visually first**, and then map each concept to technologies such as Java/Spring Boot, React, SQL, REST APIs, Docker and cloud infrastructure.